Agenda

Liquid Death

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Industry Overview

Liquid Death

Background

- Founded in 2017 by Mike Cessario
  - His discovery
- Three-fold mission
- Unique audience

Marketing Strategies

- Pilot ideas ($4500, 3M views, $1.6M)
  - Strong advertisements
- Merchandise (1/15 sales)
  - Partnerships
- "Liquid Death Country Club"

Next Steps

- How to expand its reach and popularity?
- Become the "Red Bull" of water



Alternative 1: Product Line Expansion

Liquid Death

Context

Liquid Death has built rapid growth through distinctive branding and cultural positioning; it has successfully disrupted a commodity category using identity.

Current Standing & Challenge

However, the current model is limited to:

- Still & Sparkling water
- Growth relies heavily on branding

Challenge: How can Liquid Death scale revenue and expand its market presence without losing brand identity?

Recommendation

Expand within the beverage categories, while leveraging existing brand strength

- **Introduce flavored sparkling water**
- **Introduce functional drinks (electrolytes, vitamins)**



Alternative 1: Pros & Cons

Liquid Death

PROS	CONS
Revenue without rebranding Expanding depth, not identity	**Competitive Pressure** Entering categories dominated by Red Bull & Gatorade
Proven brand extensibility $3M in merch show that customers	**Brand dilution** Risk of feeling inauthentic or "corporate"
Aligns with Gen Z trends They prioritize health and sustainability more	**Execution risk** Functional beverages require consistency

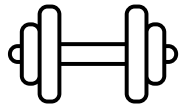


Alternative 2: New Segments, Same Brand

Liquid Death

One cultural shift. Three audiences.

1. **Athletes & Fitness Influencers**



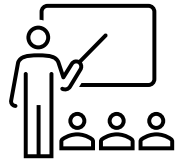
The original audience

2. **Non-drinkers/Sober curious**



The can looks like a beer

3. **College Students**



Culture does the work

Why These Work

- Culture already shifting away from alcohol
- Raised $125 million
- Monster & Red Bull proved these audiences convert

Monster Energy

Red Bull® Energy Drink

→

Liquid Death Mountain Water

Alternative 2: Pros & Cons

Liquid Death

PROS	CONS
Scales without rebranding Same identity, just aimed at more people	**Wrong influencer kills authenticity** Polished partnerships undercut everything the brand stands for
Organic influencer reach DarcSport and Young YA networks do the work	**Monster & Red Bull have roots** Displacing them takes consistent presence, not one campaign
Each segment flows into the next Athletes unlock non-drinkers, culture reaches college students	**College students are price-sensitive** Conversion depends on execution from other parts of business

Final Recommendation

Liquid Death

- Expand the product line into flavored sparkling waters + functional drinks (electrolytes, vitamins)
- Expand depth, not identity
- Lead with non-traditional athletes + fitness influencers
- Let college students follow through culture
- Never tone down the marketing

References

Ivey Business School Foundation (2022).
Liquid Death: Water Made Metal. Ivey, 2022-08-25

Ludmir, C. (2024, February 20). *Why Genz is drinking less and what this means for the alcohol industry*. Forbes. https://www.forbes.com/sites/claraludmir/2023/06/27/why-genz-is-drinking-less-and-what-this-means-for-the-alcohol-industry/

Thank You!

We are now open to questions!